

In Session

AI GENERALIST ACCELERATOR PROGRAM

AI AUTOMATIONS AND AGENTS

USE CASE - CUSTOMER SUPPORT TRIAGE BOT

Demo Video for Reference: 📺 *Build an AI Customer Support Triage Bot.mp4*

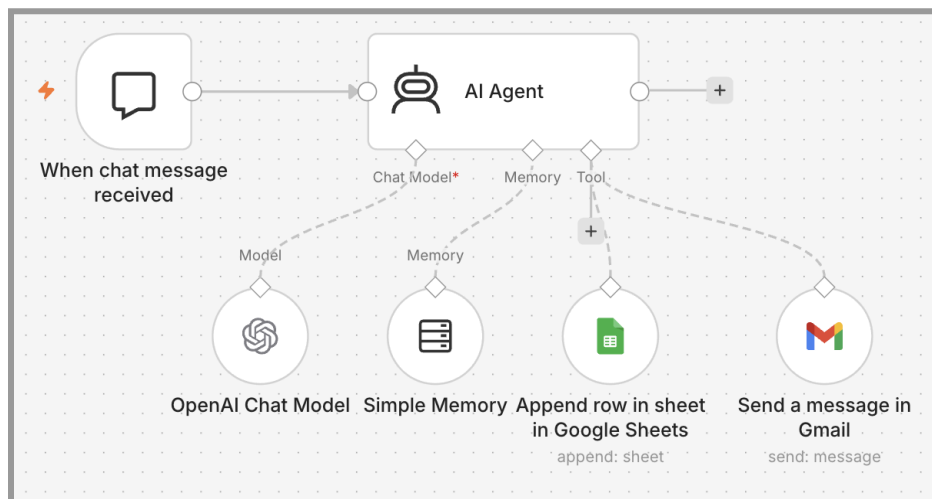
What you will you do — At a Glance

- **What you build:** An AI agent in n8n that triages customer feedback — classifies it, logs each entry to a Google Sheet, sends an acknowledgement to the customer, and escalates urgent issues to your team.
- **The stack:** n8n + OpenAI (gpt-4.1-mini) + Google Sheets + Gmail.
- **Use Case:** Chat-triggered bot. Send the agent a feedback message via the n8n chat panel and watch the full triage run end-to-end.
- **Test with 3 messages:** a High-urgency bug (Priya), a Low-urgency feature request (Rohan), a Low-urgency question (Anjali).
- **You will need:** the OpenAI API key (highlighted below), a Gmail account you can test with, and a Google Sheet named Customer Feedback Tracker.

API KEY: To be Added

Customer Support Triage Bot (Chat Trigger)

Your Final Workflow Will Look Like This



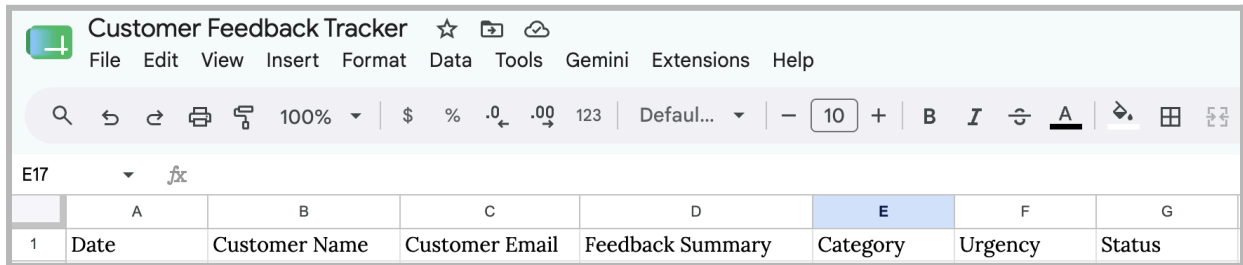
Pre-setup: Create your Google Sheet

Step 1: Create your Google Sheet. Or make a copy of this [Sample Sheet](#). (Click on the File Option-> Make a copy)

Step 2: Name the sheet **Customer Feedback Tracker**.

Step 3: Add column headers as below:

- Date
- Customer Name
- Customer Email
- Feedback Summary
- Category
- Urgency
- Status



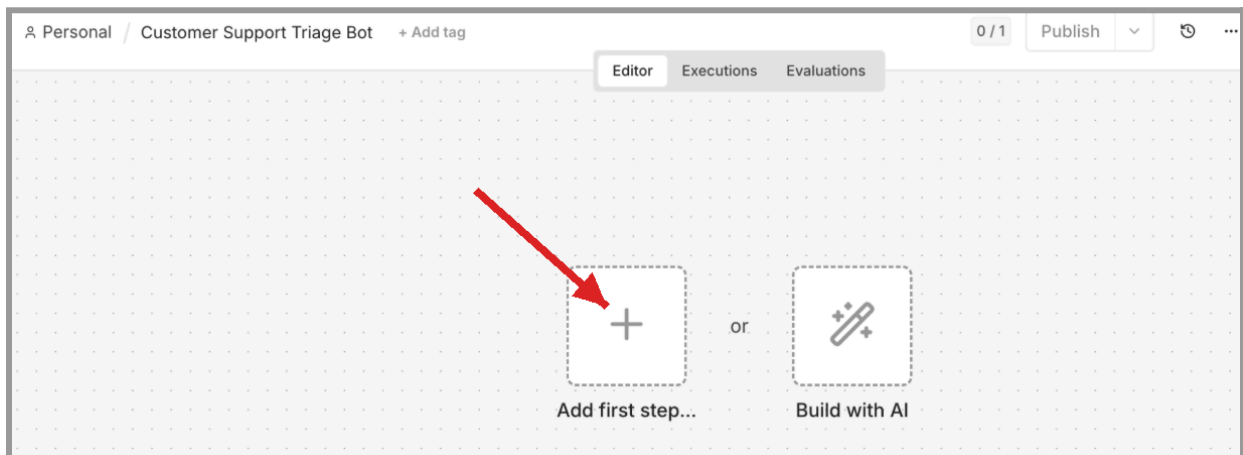
The screenshot shows a Google Sheet titled "Customer Feedback Tracker". The menu bar includes File, Edit, View, Insert, Format, Data, Tools, Gemini, Extensions, and Help. The toolbar shows various icons for search, undo, redo, print, and formatting. The active cell is E17. The spreadsheet has 8 columns labeled A through G. Row 1 contains the following headers: Date, Customer Name, Customer Email, Feedback Summary, Category, Urgency, and Status.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Date	Customer Name	Customer Email	Feedback Summary	Category	Urgency	Status

Step-by-step build (node by node)

Step 0: Create a new workflow

- Log in to your [n8n dashboard](#).
- In the top-left corner, click **Create Workflow**. A blank canvas opens with a big + in the centre.
- At the very top of the canvas, click the default name (something like *My workflow*) and rename it to **Customer Support Triage Bot**.

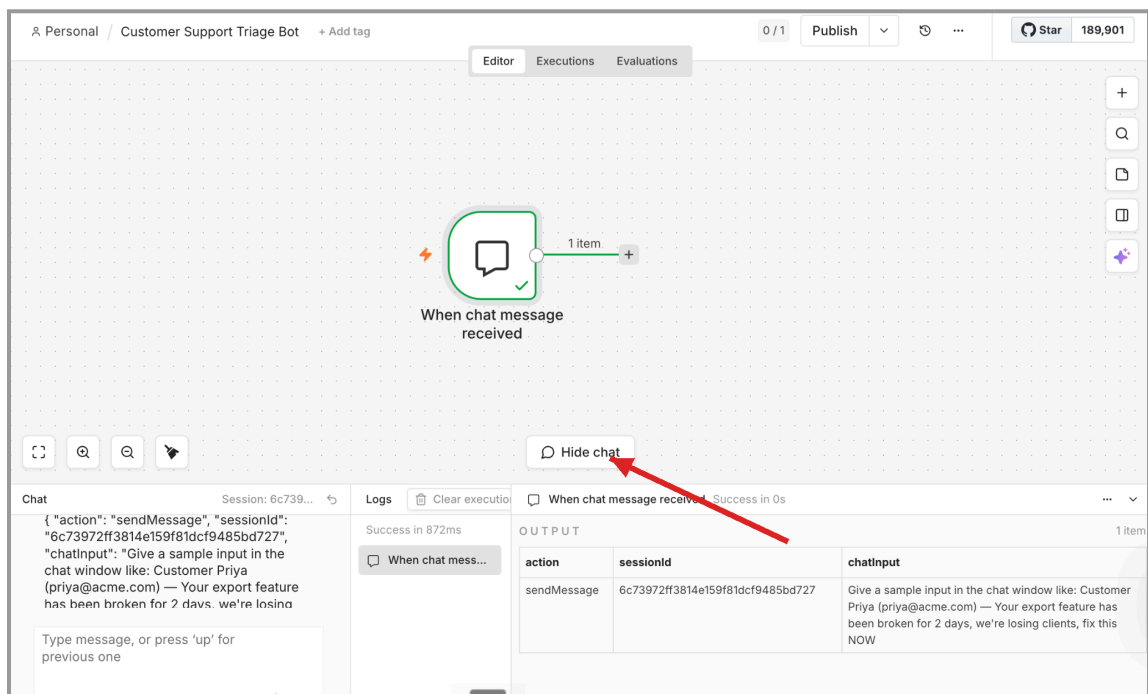


Step 1: Add trigger node

Node type: Chat Trigger

Purpose: Accept customer feedback as input.

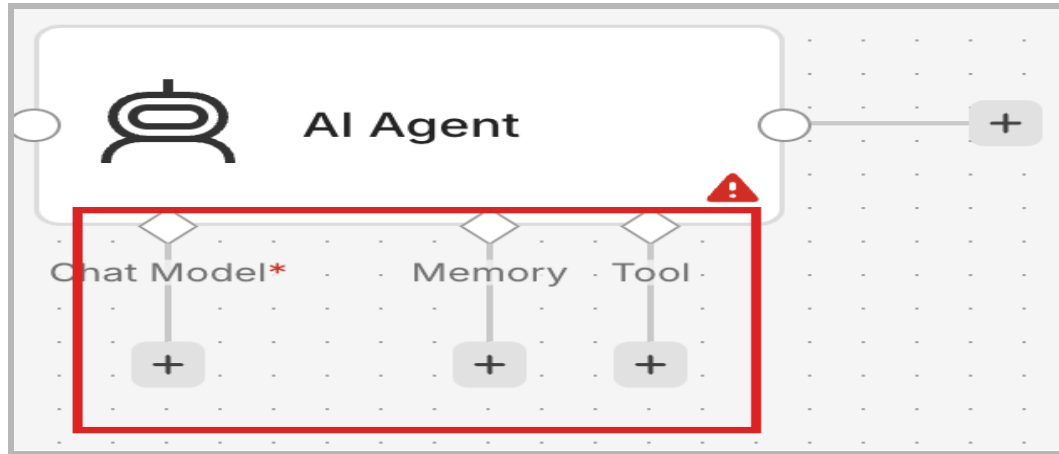
- On the empty canvas, click the big + (or **Add first step**). A search panel slides in from the right.
- Search for **Chat Trigger** and click **On chat message** to add it. The node lands on the canvas.
- Leave the default settings as they are. No config needed.
- A small chat icon appears at the bottom-centre of the canvas. You will use it in Step 8 to send a sample input like: *Customer Priya (priya@acme.com) - Your export feature has been broken for 2 days, we're losing clients, fix this NOW*
- Close the node panel.



Step 2: Add AI Agent node

Node type: AI Agent

- Click the + to the right of the Chat Trigger node.
- Search for **AI Agent** and select it. The node is added and auto-connected to the Chat Trigger.
- Leave the configuration as it is for now. We will come back to update the prompt in Step 7.
- Close the panel. You will see four small + slots underneath the AI Agent node: **Chat Model**, **Memory**, **Tool**, **Output Parser**. You will use the first three in the next steps.



Step 3: Add OpenAI Chat Model node (Brain of the Agent)

Node type: OpenAI Chat Model

- Click the + under the AI Agent labelled **Chat Model**.
- Search for **OpenAI Chat Model** and select it.
- **Credential for OpenAI API:** Click the dropdown and choose **Create new credential**.
- A side panel will open. Paste the OpenAI **API Key** shared at the top of this worksheet into the **API Key** field.
- Click **Save**. You should see a green *Connection tested successfully* message. Close the panel.
- Back in the node, **Model** dropdown: select **gpt-4.1-mini**.
- Leave all other fields at default and close the panel.

The screenshot shows the configuration panel for the OpenAI Chat Model node. It has two tabs: 'Parameters' and 'Settings'. Under 'Parameters', there is a 'Credential' section with two options: 'n8n Connect' (No API key required) and 'My own credential' (Use your own API key). Below this is an 'OpenAI account' dropdown. The 'Model' section is highlighted with a red box, showing a dropdown menu with 'From list' and 'gpt-4.1-mini'. There is also a 'Use Responses API' toggle switch. At the bottom, there is an 'Options' section with a '+ Add Option' button. A footer text says 'I wish this node would...'.

Step 4: Add a Simple Memory node

Node type: Simple Memory

Purpose: Keep recent context across messages so the agent can handle follow-ups from the same customer.

- Click the + under the AI Agent labelled **Memory**.
- Search for **Simple Memory** and select it.
- **Session ID:** Leave as **Connected Chat Trigger Node** (default).
- **Context Window Length:** Set to 5.
- Close the panel.

The screenshot shows the configuration panel for the 'Simple Memory' node in n8n. The panel has two tabs: 'Parameters' (selected) and 'Settings'. A yellow warning box at the top states: 'This node stores memory locally in the n8n instance. It is not compatible with Queue Mode or Multi-Main setups, as memory will not be shared across workers. For production use with scaling, consider using an external memory store such as Redis, Postgres, or another persistent memory node.' Below this, the 'Session ID' dropdown is set to 'Connected Chat Trigger Node'. The 'Session Key From Previous Node' field contains a JavaScript expression: `fx {{ $json.sessionId }}`. Below the expression, a long alphanumeric string is displayed: `6c73972ff3814e159f81dcf9485bd727`. Another yellow warning box states: 'Session is automatically scoped only to this memory node. To share a session between different memory nodes, switch "Session ID" to "Define below" and use the same key in each node.' The 'Context Window Length' input field is highlighted with a red rectangle and contains the value '5'. Below this field, a description reads: 'How many past interactions the model receives as context'. At the bottom of the panel, there is a feedback link: '🗨 I wish this node would...'.

Step 5: Add Google Sheets Append Row node (logging tool)

Node type: Google Sheets Tool

- Click the + under the AI Agent labelled **Tool**.
- Search for **Google Sheets** and select the **Google Sheets Tool** (not the regular Google Sheets node).

- **Credential to connect with:** Click the dropdown and choose **Create new credential**.
- A side panel opens. Click **Sign in with Google** and pick the Google account that owns the **Customer Feedback Tracker** sheet. Grant the requested permissions.
- You return to n8n with the credential connected. Click **Save** and close the panel.
- **Operation:** Append Row in Sheet
- **Document:** Click the dropdown and pick **Customer Feedback Tracker**. If it does not appear, paste the sheet URL.
- **Sheet:** Pick the tab inside the document (usually **Sheet1**).
- **Mapping Column Mode:** Set to **Map Each Column Manually**. Your seven sheet columns now appear as fields.
- For each column (Date, Customer Name, Customer Email, Feedback Summary, Category, Urgency, Status), click the small star/fx toggle next to the field and switch it to **Filled by AI**.

- Close the panel.

Parameters

Settings

Execute step

Credential

Google Sheets OAuth2 API

Tool Description

Set Automatically

Resource

Sheet Within Document

Operation

Append Row

Document

From list

Customer Feedback T...

Sheet

From list

Sheet1

Mapping Column Mode

Map Each Column Manually

The screenshot shows the 'Parameters' tab in the n8n interface. At the top, there are tabs for 'Parameters' and 'Settings', and an 'Execute step' button. Below the tabs, a list of parameters is displayed, each with a trash icon, a name, a value field, and a description field. The 'Date' parameter is highlighted with a red box. The value field for 'Date' contains the text 'Defined automatically by the model'. The other parameters are 'Customer Name', 'Customer Email', 'Feedback Summary', 'Category', 'Urgency', and 'Status', all of which also have the value 'Defined automatically by the model'.

Parameter Name	Value	Description
Date	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description
Customer Name	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description
Customer Email	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description
Feedback Summary	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description
Category	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description
Urgency	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description
Status	Defined automatically by the model	+ Add a description

Step 6: Add Gmail Tool

Node type: Gmail Tool

Purpose: The agent uses this for two things: (a) sending an acknowledgement email to the customer for every feedback received, and (b) sending an escalation email to the internal team **ONLY** when Urgency is High. The agent decides on its own which email to send.

- Click the + under the AI Agent labelled **Tool** to add another tool.
- Search for **Gmail** and select **Gmail Tool** (not the Gmail Trigger and not the regular Gmail node).
- **Credential to connect with:** Click the dropdown and choose **Create new credential**.
- A side panel opens. Click **Sign in with Google** and pick a Gmail account you can read the inbox of (so you can verify the emails arrive during testing). Grant the requested permissions.
- You return to n8n with the credential connected. Click **Save** and close the panel.
- **Tool Description:** Set Automatically
- **Resource:** Message
- **Operation:** Send

- **To:** Click the star/fx toggle next to the field and set it to **Filled by AI** (the agent will pick the customer email or your team email based on the situation).
- **Subject:** Toggle to **Filled by AI**.
- **Message:** Toggle to **Filled by AI**.
- **Email Type:** Text
- Close the panel.

The screenshot shows a configuration panel with the following fields:

- Credential:** Gmail account 2
- Tool Description:** Set Automatically
- Resource:** Message
- Operation:** Send
- To:** Defined automatically by the model
- Subject:** Defined automatically by the model
- Email Type:** Text
- Message:** Defined automatically by the model

Step 7: Configure the agent prompt

- Double-click the AI Agent node to open its configuration.
- Scroll down to the **Options** section. If it is collapsed, click to expand it.
- Click **Add Option** and choose **System Message** from the menu. A text field appears.
- Click the **Expression** toggle (the **fx** icon next to the field) so it accepts multi-line text.
- Paste the system message below in full (read it once before pasting to understand the logic).

System Message:

You are a customer support triage assistant. When you receive a piece of customer feedback, analyse it and extract the following:

1. Customer Name
2. Customer Email
3. Feedback Summary (one short line)
4. Category (Bug / Feature Request / Complaint / Question / Praise)
5. Urgency:
 - High: blocks the customer's work, mentions revenue or business loss, or contains urgency words like ASAP, urgent, critical, broken, can't, down, blocking.
 - Medium: functional issue or notable complaint without a blocker.
 - Low: praise, minor suggestion, or general question.

After every triage, use the Google Sheets tool to append a row with the extracted fields, today's date, and Status = "New".

Then use the Gmail tool to send a warm, personalised acknowledgement email to the customer (use the Customer Email). Reference their specific issue by name and confirm we've received it.

If Urgency = High, ALSO use the Gmail tool to send an escalation email to team@yourcompany.com with the full feedback details, urgency level, and customer email so the team can act fast.

Note: Replace **team@yourcompany.com** with the **actual team email** you want escalations sent to. For testing, use your own email.

- Close the panel.

Parameters
Settings
Execute step

Tip: Get a feel for agents with our quick [tutorial](#) or see an [example](#) of how this node works

Source for Prompt (User Message)
Connected Chat Trigger Node

Prompt (User Message)
fx {{ \$json.chatInput }}

Give a sample input in the chat window like: Custom...

☐ Require Specific Output Format

☐ Enable Fallback Model

Options
+

System Message ⓘ
Fixed Expression

fx
You are a customer support triage assistant. When you receive a piece of customer feedback, analyse it and extract the following:

1. Customer Name
2. Customer Email

Result
Item C < >
If Urgency = High, ALSO use the Gmail tool to send an escalation email to shasti.shree@outskill.com with the full feedback details, urgency level, and customer email so the team can act fast.

Step 8: Test the workflow

- Click the small chat icon at the bottom-centre of the canvas. The chat window opens.
- Send each of the three messages below one at a time. Wait for the agent's reply before sending the next.
- **Customer Priya** (priya@acme.com) – Your export feature has been broken for 2 days, we're losing clients, fix this NOW → expected: Category = Bug, Urgency = High, customer acknowledgement + team escalation email
- **Customer Rohan** (rohan@startup.in) – Loving the new dashboard, would be great to have a dark mode option → expected: Category = Feature Request, Urgency = Low, customer acknowledgement only

- **Customer Anjali** (anjali@retail.com) – How do I invite team members to my account?
→ expected: Category = Question, Urgency = Low, customer acknowledgement only

Now check the outputs:

- Google Sheet → a new row should appear for each message with the correct Category and Urgency.
- Customer test inbox → an acknowledgement email should arrive for every message (use a test email you control).
- Team inbox → ONLY the first (High urgency) message should trigger an escalation email.

Urgent Escalation: Export Feature Bug Report from Customer Priya

Inbox x

T

Tools Outskill

to me

5:26 PM (2 minutes ago)

☆

😊

↶

⋮

Customer Priya (priya@acme.com) has reported that the export feature has been broken for 2 days and is causing loss of clients. This is a high urgency issue that needs immediate attention.

Please prioritize and resolve this as soon as possible.

Thank you.

This email was sent automatically with n8n
<https://n8n.io>

↶ Reply

↷ Forward

😊

💬 Share in chat

New

Customer Feedback Tracker							
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Gemini Extensions Help							
D13							
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Date	Customer Name	Customer Email	Feedback Summary	Category	Urgency	Status
2	2024-06-15	Priya	priya@acme.com	Export feature has been broken for 2 days	Bug	High	New
3	2024-06-15	Rohan	rohan@startup.in	Loving the new dashboard	Feature Request	Low	New

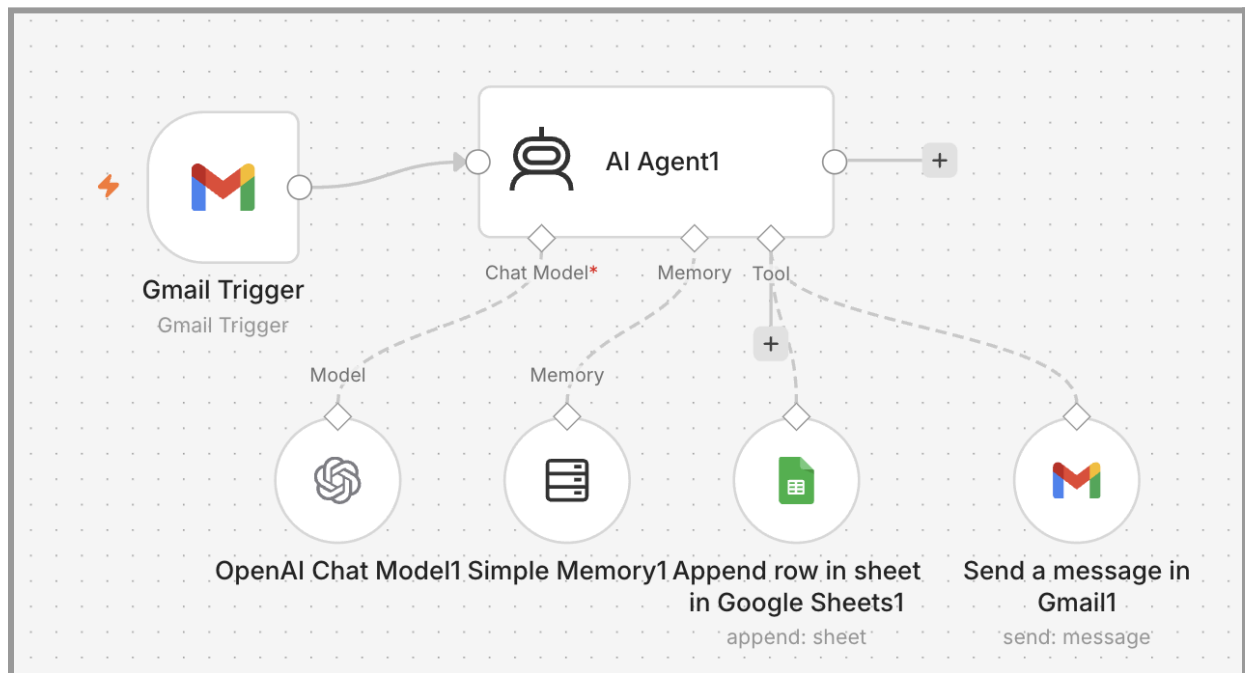
Optional(Post Session)

Use Case 2 (Optional) - Upgrading the Bot with a Gmail Trigger

Optional - try this after class. Swap the Chat Trigger for a Gmail Trigger so the bot listens to a real inbox. The AI Agent, brain, Memory, Google Sheets Tool and Gmail Tool from Use Case 1 stay the same. You only change the input source and tweak the prompt.

Pre-requisite: Use Case 1 must be complete and working.

Your Final Workflow Will Look Like This



Step-by-step build (node by node)

Step 1: Open your existing workflow

- Open the Customer Support Triage Bot workflow you built in Use Case 1.
- Make a copy of the Workflow.

Step 2: Delete the Chat Trigger .

- Drag the Chat Trigger off to the side of the canvas. **delete it.**

Step 3: Add the Gmail Trigger node

Node type: Gmail Trigger

Purpose: Listen to your Gmail inbox and fire the workflow whenever a new matching email arrives.

- Click the + to the left of the AI Agent (where the Chat Trigger used to connect).
- Search for **Gmail Trigger** (make sure it is the Trigger, not the Gmail Tool).
- Select **On message received**. The node lands on the canvas.
- **Credential to connect with:** Click the dropdown. If you used the same Gmail account for the Gmail Tool in Use Case 1, **pick that existing credential** from the list. Otherwise, click **Create new credential**, sign in with Google, grant permissions, click **Save**, and close the panel.

Step 4: Configure the Gmail Trigger

- **Poll Times** → **Mode:** Every Minute
- **Event:** Message Received
- **Simplify:** Toggle ON (this gives clean fields like **From**, **Subject**, **text** instead of raw Gmail JSON).
- **Max Emails per Poll:** 10 (safety cap so the bot does not process 50 emails at once).

Step 5: Add filters to the Gmail Trigger

Purpose: Make the bot focus only on actual customer support emails (not newsletters, OTPs, or promos).

Filter 1 — Search by keywords

- Add Filter → **Search** → paste the query below:

subject:(issue OR problem OR broken OR bug OR error OR help OR support OR urgent OR "not working" OR ASAP OR critical OR "can't" OR cannot OR feedback OR complaint OR request) OR ("facing an issue" OR "facing issue" OR "having trouble" OR "doesn't work" OR "stopped working" OR "need help")

Filter 2 — Skip Spam and Trash

- Add Filter → **Include Spam and Trash** → toggle OFF.

Filter 3 — Skip Drafts

- Add Filter → **Include Drafts** → toggle OFF.

Filter 4 (optional, recommended) — Only Unread emails

- Add Filter → **Read Status** → **Unread emails only**.

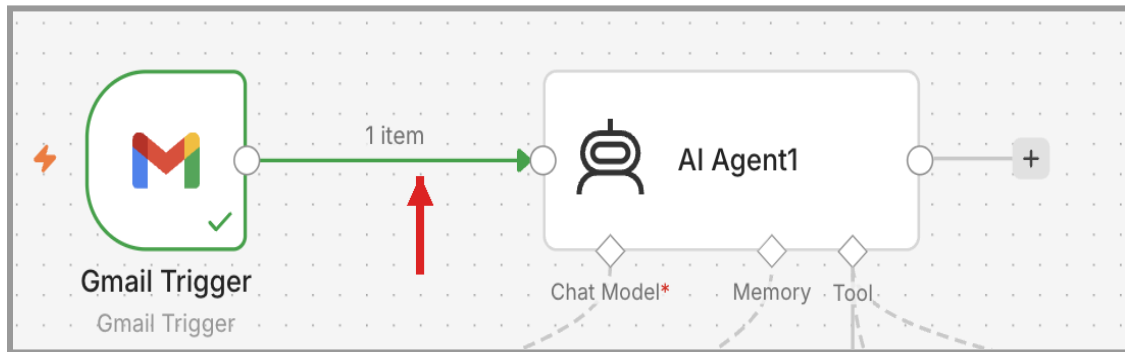
Step 6: Test that the Gmail Trigger can fetch emails

- From a different email account, send a test email to the Gmail account connected to n8n.
- **Subject:** URGENT - export feature broken
- **Body:** Hi team, my export feature has been broken for the last 2 days. We have a board meeting tomorrow and this is blocking my work. Please fix ASAP. - Test User
- Wait ~10 seconds, then click **Fetch Test Event** on the Gmail Trigger.
- The **OUTPUT** panel should show fields like From, Subject, text.

	From	To	Subject
1 item	Pabbly <admin@pabbly.com>	tools@outskill.com	Resend Failed WhatsApp Broadcasts in One Click

Step 7: Connect the Gmail Trigger to the AI Agent

- Drag a line from the right side of the Gmail Trigger to the left side of the AI Agent.



Step 8: Update the Simple Memory node's Session ID

Purpose: The Chat Trigger provided a sessionId automatically. The Gmail Trigger does not, so we need to set one.

- Open **Simple Memory**.
- Session ID dropdown: change to **Define below**.
- Click the expression toggle (**fx**) and paste:

```
={{ $('Gmail Trigger').item.json.From || 'default-session' }}
```

- Leave Context Window Length at 5.

The screenshot shows the 'Parameters' tab of the 'Simple Memory' node configuration. At the top, there is a text box with a warning: 'This node stores memory locally in the n8n instance. It is not compatible with Queue Mode or Multi-Main setups, as memory will not be shared across workers. For production use with scaling, consider using an external memory store such as Redis, Postgres, or another persistent memory node.' Below this, the 'Session ID' dropdown menu is set to 'Define below'. The 'Key' field is empty. The 'fx' (expression) toggle is active, and the expression editor contains the code: `={{ $('Gmail Trigger').item.json.From || 'default-session' }}`. Below the expression editor, the 'Context Window Length' is set to 5, with a description: 'How many past interactions the model receives as context'.

Step 9: Update the AI Agent's input source

Purpose: Tell the agent which email fields to read (From, Subject, Body).

- Open **AI Agent**.
- Change **Prompt (User Message)** from **Take from previous node automatically** to **Define below**.
- Click the expression toggle (**fx**) and paste:

```
=From: {{ $json.From }}
```

```
Subject: {{ $json.Subject }}
```

Body:

```
{{ $json.text || $json.snippet || $json.textPlain }}
```

Parameters

Settings

Execute step

Tip: Get a feel for agents with our quick [tutorial](#) or see an [example](#) of how this node works

Source for Prompt (User Message)

Define below

Prompt (User Message)

fx

```
=From: {{ $json.From }}  
Subject: {{ $json.Subject }}  
  
Body:  
{{ $json.text || $json.snippet || $json.textPlain }}
```

=From: Pabbly <admin@pabbly.com> Subject: ...

Require Specific Output Format

Enable Fallback Model

Step 10: Update the AI Agent's system prompt

Purpose: Teach the agent to read email fields and to skip non-support emails (newsletters, OTPs, spam).

- Inside **AI Agent** → **Options** → **System Message**.
- Clear the existing prompt and paste the new one below.

You are a customer support triage assistant that processes incoming emails. Your job is to decide whether each email is a genuine customer support request, and if so, triage it.

STEP 1 — DECIDE IF THIS IS A SUPPORT EMAIL:

It IS a support email if it contains:

- A bug, issue, error, or something not working
- A complaint or frustration about the product
- A feature request or suggestion
- A question about how to use the product
- Praise or positive feedback about the product

It is NOT a support email if it is:

- A newsletter, marketing email, or promotional offer
- An OTP, verification code, or automated notification
- A receipt, invoice, or transactional confirmation
- A LinkedIn or social media notification
- A cold sales outreach or recruitment email
- Spam or anything unrelated to your product

IF IT IS NOT A SUPPORT EMAIL: Do nothing. Do not call any tools. Do not log to Google Sheets. Do not send any email. Just respond with the single line: "Skipped — not a support email."

STEP 2 — IF IT IS A SUPPORT EMAIL, TRIAGE IT:

The input you receive will be an actual email with a "From" address, "Subject" line, and "Body". Extract the following:

1. Customer Name — derive from the From field (the part before the email address, or infer from the email signature in the body)
2. Customer Email — use the email address from the From field
3. Feedback Summary — one short line combining the Subject and key points from the Body
4. Category (Bug / Feature Request / Complaint / Question / Praise)
5. Urgency:
 - High: blocks the customer's work, mentions revenue or business loss, or contains urgency words like ASAP, urgent, critical, broken, can't, down, blocking.

- Medium: functional issue or notable complaint without a blocker.
- Low: praise, minor suggestion, or general question.

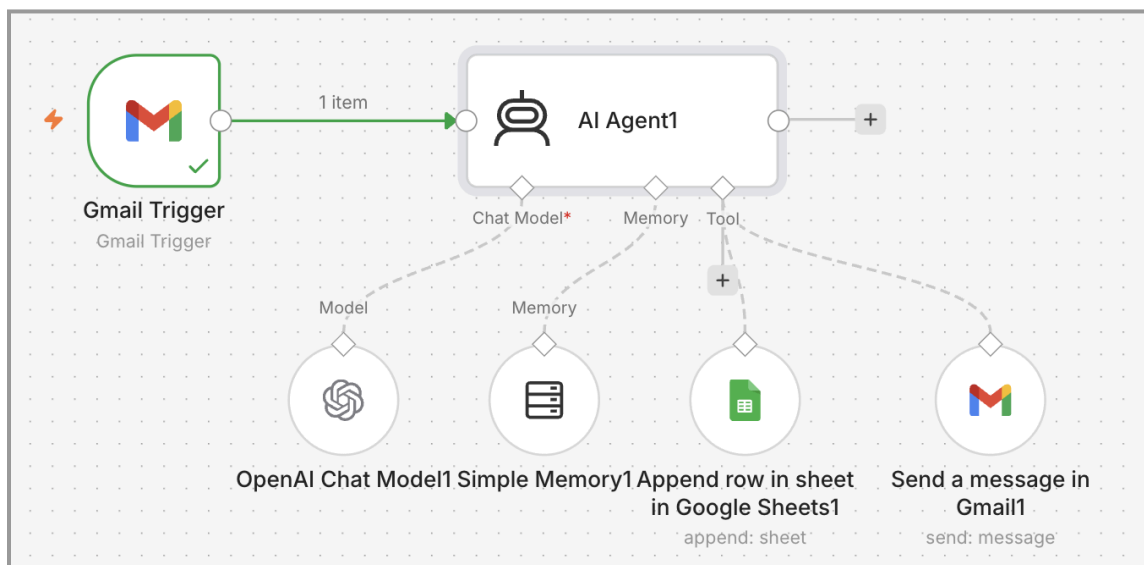
Then:

- Use the Google Sheets tool to append a row with the extracted fields, today's date, and Status = "New".
- Use the Gmail tool to send a warm, personalized acknowledgement email to the customer (use the Customer Email). Reference their specific issue and confirm we've received it.
- If Urgency = High, ALSO use the Gmail tool to send an escalation email to your-team-email@example.com with the full feedback details, urgency level, and customer email so the team can act fast.

Note: Replace **your-team-email@example.com** with the actual team email you want escalations sent to.

Step 11: Save the workflow

- Click **Save** in the top-right corner. Unsaved changes will not run when the workflow is activated.



Step 12: Test the workflow end-to-end

Send these test emails from any other email to your email that you added in **Step 10's system prompt:** . For each one, either wait one minute for polling or click Fetch Test Event → Test Workflow.

- **Test 1 – High urgency support email**

- Subject: URGENT – export feature broken
- Body: Hi team, your export feature has been broken for 2 days, we're losing clients, fix this NOW. – Priya
- Expected: Sheet row added (Bug, High, New), acknowledgement email, escalation email.
- **Test 2 – A non-support email (should be skipped)**
- Subject: Your weekly newsletter is here!
- Body: Here are this week's top stories in tech...
- Expected: No sheet row, no emails. Agent should respond Skipped – not a support email.
- **Now verify everything:**
- Google Sheet → exactly 1 row added (from Test 1 only).
- Sender inbox → 1 acknowledgement email.
- Team inbox → exactly 1 escalation email (from Test 1).
- Test 2 should leave no trace.

Date	Customer Name	Customer Email	Feedback Summary	Category	Urgency	Status
2024-06-08	Shasti Shree V	shasti.shree@growth	Dark mode request - Loving	Feature Request	Low	New

T

Tools Outskill
to me ▾

Hi Shasti Shree V,

Thank you so much for your kind words about our new dashboard! We also appreciate your suggestion for a dark mode option. We've received your request and will consider it as we continue to improve our product.

Best regards,
The Support Team

This email was sent automatically with n8n
<https://n8n.io>

Thank you for your feature suggestion: Dark mode request

Inbox x

Step 13: Activate the workflow for live use

- In the top-right corner of n8n, flip the **Inactive / Active** toggle to **Active** after publishing.
- n8n will now poll your Gmail inbox every minute and process matching emails on its own.
- **Important:** Turn the workflow OFF when you are done testing so it does not keep running and burning credits.